

Lesson 1: The Big Chair

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Ah, responsibility. It's a word you've heard over and over and over again. If you're watching this video, chances are you know a thing or two about responsibility at your organization.

Pat believed responsibility was key to having success as a leader. Not just personal success, but going beyond that to instill a sense of responsibility in your team. Easier said than done, right? There are certain steps to walking through this art of cultivating responsibility, which we'll get to in a moment.

But first, take a minute to think about where you are at your organization. In what areas does responsibility come most naturally? In what areas do you wish you could step up your own responsibility or encourage a little more responsibility among your team members? Even more important, what could your group accomplish if everyone understood the concept of being responsible? Not only for the output in their area, but the shared mission of the team. Pat believed a few simple principles were necessary when it comes to being a leader.

You have to have responsibility for everything. If the ship is on fire, it's your responsibility. If the boat doesn't have enough gas, it's your responsibility. If the team didn't bring enough snacks for the trip, it's your responsibility.

You have to instill responsibility in your team. As a leader, you can't go around shouldering 100% of the burden. Not if you want to be able to lead effectively and grow a capable team underneath you. They, too, must have levels of responsibility and tasks they are uniquely accountable for. You have to look for intentional ways to encourage responsibility on your team.

That brings us to the last point. You have to clearly define who is responsible for what. And you have to actively cultivate different levels of responsibility.

Pat believed in starting small and working team members into greater levels of accountability. Everyone on the team had things they were accountable for, with no one being a spectator. We'll explore these concepts and more in the following lessons.